



Clockwise from facing page: A snow leopard in Ladakh; a family of lemurs and a prancing sifaka in Madagascar; a baby orangutan hangs off a branch in Borneo

LEMURS IN MADAGASCAR

The wildlife of Madagascar is defined by endemism rather than megafauna. Lemurs (aka King Julian)—the primary attraction—occur naturally only in this African nation. The haunting, foghorn-like calls of the indri will stay with you long after you leave, as will the unique sideways dancing hop of the ground sifakas. It's a nation tailormade for safaris beyond the 'Big 5'—even more so if you add the myriad endemic birds that reside here. Plan a stay at barefoot luxury beach retreats or upscale river camps.

Recommended stay: *Miavana by Time + Tide; starts from US$7,400 for double occupancy; additional conservation levy of US$300 per person, per night*

ORANGUTANS IN BORNEO

The time to explore one of the planet's oldest rainforests is rapidly running out—the island nation of Borneo in the Malay Archipelago's Greater Sunda Islands is losing its beautiful ecosystem to rampant palm oil production. In the meantime, try to experience a private water safari down the Kinabatangan River to spot the 'Borneo Big 5' of pygmy elephants, orangutans, proboscis monkeys (it's one of the last natural habitats for these three endangered species), hornbills, and crocodiles.

Recommended stay: *Borneo Rainforest Lodge; 3-day/2-night packages start from ~US$2700 for double occupancy; high season surcharges may apply*

> "In our hands now lies not only our own future, but that of all other living creatures with whom we share the Earth."
> *— Sir David Attenborough*



POLAR BEARS & PENGUINS IN THE POLES

If a once-in-a-lifetime experience is what the traveller in you wants, an adventure to the poles is your answer. In the south, an Antarctic penguin safari involves expedition cruises, Zodiac boat excursions, and guided shore landings. The itineraries involve exploring the Antarctic Peninsula and the neighbouring South Shetland Islands, where you can find colonies of gentoo, chinstrap, and Adélie